



**Verified Carbon
Standard**

EVERGREEN II REDD+ PROJECT



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1 PROJECT DETAILS

1.1 Summary Description of the Project

The Evergreen II REDD+ project aims at protecting forests located in one of the regions with the highest deforestation rate in the Amazon Biome: the municipality of Apuí. The South of the municipality has already been reached by the “Arc of Deforestation”. In the last 10 years, Apuí has been one of the most deforested municipalities in the Amazon Biome¹. Besides the damage caused to natural ecosystems, the land-use changes have provoked severe social conflicts through processes of land-grabbing and installation of agriculture and cattle ranching activities, contributing to the expulsion of family-scale forest extractives from that region.

In the Apuí region, the deforestation pressure originated from the neighboring States of Pará and Rondônia. These states have already undergone intense deforestation processes in the past, mainly due to the expansion of agriculture and cattle ranching.

According to Carrero and Fearnside (2011)² deforestation in Apuí is mainly related to the accumulation of land by a few, which results from low rate of titling regulation and inadequate governance.

The primary objective of the Evergreen II REDD+ project is to avoid unplanned (AUD) deforestation in an area of 36,989.62 hectares of Amazonian forest, equating to 6,191,013.12 tCO₂e in emissions reductions over the 30-year project lifetime (25-November-2020 to 24-November-2050), with an annual average of 206,367.10 tCO₂e.

1.2 Audit History

As this project is presently under development, this section will be updated at the time of project validation to include the monitoring periods.

¹ PRODES. Available at: <http://terrabrasilis.dpi.inpe.br/app/dashboard/deforestation/biomes/amazon/increments>. Last access: 11/07/2023.

² Carrero, G.C; Fearnside, P.M. (2011). Forest clearing dynamics and the expansion of landholdings in Apuí, a deforestation on Brazil's transamazon highway. Ecology an Society, vol 16, n 2, art.26. Available at: <https://www.ecologyandsociety.org/vol16/iss2/art26/>. Last access: 11/08/2023.

1.3 Sectoral Scope and Project Type

Sectoral scope	Agriculture, forestry and other land use (AFOLU)
AFOLU project category	Reduced Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD)
Project activity type	Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation (AUD)

1.4 Project Eligibility

1.4.1 General eligibility

According to the VCS Standard v.4.5³ regarding Reduced Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD) projects, eligible activities are those which reduce net GHG emissions by reducing deforestation which is the case for this project activities. The general eligibility conditions present in this document and justifications for assistance under the Evergreen II REDD+ project are presented in the table below.

General Eligibility Conditions	Evergreen II REDD+ project Justification of Eligibility
Projects shall meet all applicable rules and requirements set out under the VCS Program, including this document. Projects shall be guided by the principles set out in Section 2.2.1	The project meets all applicable rules and requirements set out under the VCS Program, as detailed in this section and in Applicability of Methodology.
Projects shall apply methodologies eligible under the VCS Program. Methodologies shall be applied in full, including the full application of any tools or modules referred to by a methodology, noting the exception set out in Section 3.13.1	The applied methodology is VM0007 - REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD+MF), v1.6. Applicability conditions are detailed in section 3.2.
Projects shall apply the latest version of the applicable methodology in all cases unless a grace period applies to the project as set out in 3.22 below. Projects shall update to the latest version of the methodology when reassessing the baseline or renewing a crediting period.	The project applies the latest version of the applicable methodology: VM0007 REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD+MF), v1.6. The project will be updated to the latest version of the methodology when reassessing the baseline or renewing a crediting period.

³ VCS Standard. Available at: <https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/08/VCS-Standard-v4.5-updated-4-Oct-2023.pdf>. Last access: 11/07/2023.

Projects and the implementation of project activities shall not lead to the violation of any applicable law, regardless of whether the law is enforced.	The project activity involves the conservation of native Tropical Rainforests. These activities are eligible under Brazilian law according to conditions set out in section 1.15.
Where projects apply methodologies that permit the project proponent its own choice of model (see the VCS Program document Program Definitions for definition of model), such model shall meet with the requirements set out in the VCS Program document VCS Methodology Requirements, and it shall be demonstrated at validation that the model is appropriate to the project circumstances (i.e., use of the model will lead to an appropriate quantification of GHG emission reductions or removals).	Not applicable. The project applies the VM0007 methodology.
Where projects apply methodologies that permit the project proponent its own choice of third party default factor or standard to ascertain GHG emission data and any supporting data for establishing baseline scenarios and demonstrating additionality, such default factor or standard shall meet with the requirements set out in the VCS Program document <i>VCS Methodology Requirements</i> .	Not applicable. The project applies VM0007 methodology, in addition to the VT0001 for Additionality assessment.
Projects shall preferentially apply methodologies that use performance methods (see the VCS Program document VCS Methodology Requirements for further information on performance methods) where a methodology is applicable to the project that uses a performance method for determining both additionality and the crediting baseline (i.e., a project shall not apply a methodology that uses a project method where such a performance method is applicable to the project).	Not applicable. The project applies VM0007 methodology, in addition to the VT0001 for Additionality assessment.
Where the rules and requirements under an approved GHG program conflict with the rules and requirements of the VCS Program, the rules and requirements of the VCS Program shall take precedence.	The project applies approved VCS methodology and tools. The project shall take precedence over the rules and requirements of the VCS Program over other approved GHG Programs.

Where projects apply methodologies from approved GHG programs, they shall comply with any specified capacity limits (see the VCS Program document Program Definitions for definition of capacity limit) and any other relevant requirements set out regarding the application of the methodology and/or tools referenced by the methodology under those programs.	The project applies approved VCS methodology and tools. The project shall take precedence over the rules and requirements of the VCS Program over other approved GHG Programs.
Where Verra issues new requirements relating to projects, registered projects do not need to adhere to the new requirements for the remainder of their project crediting periods (i.e., such projects remain eligible to issue VCUs through to the end of their project crediting period without revalidation against the new requirements). The new requirements shall be adhered to at the project crediting period renewal, as set out in Section 3.8.9.	The project was designed under VCS Standard version 4.5 and VM0007 REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD+MF), v1.6. Any new requirements shall be adhered to at the project crediting period renewal (i.e. six years from the Project Start Date).

1.4.2 AFOLU project eligibility

The AFOLU project is eligible under the scopes of the VCS Program, following the VCS Standard version 4.5⁴, sections 3.2 and Appendix A1.5 – A1.8. The AFOLU eligibility conditions present in this document and justifications for assistance under the Evergreen II REDD+ project are presented in the table below.

AFOLU Eligibility Conditions	Evergreen II REDD+ project Justification of Eligibility
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⁴ VERRA – VCS Standard. Available at: <https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/08/VCS-Standard-v4.5.pdf>. Last access: 11/07/2023.

There are currently six AFOLU project categories eligible under the VCS Program, as defined in Appendix 1 Eligible AFOLU Project Categories below: afforestation, reforestation and revegetation (ARR), agricultural land management (ALM), improved forest management (IFM), reduced emissions from deforestation and degradation (REDD), avoided conversion of grasslands and shrublands (ACoGS), and wetland restoration and conservation (WRC).	This is an eligible AFOLU project category under the VCS Program: Reduced Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD).
Where projects are located within a jurisdiction covered by a jurisdictional REDD+ program, project proponents shall follow the requirements in this document and the requirements related to nested projects set out in the VCS Program document Jurisdictional and Nested REDD+ Requirements.	This project is not located within a jurisdiction covered by a jurisdictional REDD+ program.
Where an implementation partner is acting in partnership with the project proponent, the implementation partner shall be identified in the project description. The implementation partner shall identify its roles and responsibilities regarding the project, including but not limited to, implementation, management and monitoring of the project, over the project crediting period	Any implementation partners are described in the project description and sections 1.6 and 1.7.
Activities that convert native ecosystems to generate GHG credits are not eligible under the VCS Program. Evidence shall be provided in the project description that any ARR, ALM, WRC or ACoGS project areas were not cleared of native ecosystems to create GHG credits (e.g., evidence indicating that clearing occurred due to natural disasters such as hurricanes or floods). Such proof is not required where such clearing or conversion took place at least 10 years before the proposed project start date.	This project does not convert native ecosystems to generate GHG. The project area only contains native forested land for a minimum of 10 years before the project start date.

Activities that drain native ecosystems or degrade hydrological functions to generate GHG credits are not eligible under the VCS Program. Evidence shall be provided in the project description that any AFOLU project area was not drained or converted to create GHG credits. Such proof is not required where such draining or conversion took place before 1 January 2008.	This project does not occur on wetlands and does not drain native ecosystems or degrade hydrological functions.
The project proponent shall demonstrate that project activities that lead to the intended GHG benefit have been implemented during each verification period in accordance with the project design. Where no new project activities have been implemented during a verification period, project proponents shall demonstrate that previously implemented project activities continued to be implemented during the verification period (e.g., forest patrols or improved agricultural practices of community members).	PPs will demonstrate that project activities that lead to the intended GHG benefit have been implemented during each verification period in accordance with the project design.
For all IFM, APDD (except where the agent is unknown), RWE, APWD, APC, and ALM project types, the project proponent shall, for the duration of the project, reassess the baseline every ten years and have this validated at the same time as the subsequent verification. For all AUDD, APDD (where the agent is unknown), AUC and AUWD project types, the project proponent shall, for the duration of the project, reassess the baseline every six years and have this validated at the same time as the subsequent verification.	The baseline reassessment will be conducted every six years as the project includes AUD.
Where ARR, ALM, IFM or REDD project activities occur on wetlands, the project shall adhere to both the respective project category requirements and the WRC requirements, unless the expected emissions from the soil organic carbon pool or change in the soil organic carbon pool in the project scenario is deemed below de minimis or can be conservatively excluded as set out in the VCS Program document VCS Methodology Requirements, in which	Not applicable. The project activity does not occur on wetlands.

case the project shall not be subject to the WRC requirements.	
Projects shall prepare a non-permanence risk report in accordance with the VCS Program document AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool for both validation and verification. In the case of projects that are not validated and verified simultaneously, having their initial risk assessments validated at the time of VCS project validation will assist VCU buyers and sellers by providing a more accurate early indication of the number of VCUs projects are expected to generate. The non-permanence risk report shall be prepared using the VCS Non-Permanence Risk Report Template, which may be included as an annex to the project description or monitoring report, as applicable, or provided as a stand-alone document.	The project has conducted a non-permanence risk analysis according to the VCS Program Document AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool, v4.1 ⁵ for validation and shall prepare the report during subsequent verifications.
Eligible REDD activities are those that reduce net GHG emissions by reducing deforestation and/or degradation of forests. The project area shall meet an internationally accepted definition of forest, such as those based on UNFCCC host country thresholds or FAO definitions, and shall qualify as forest for a minimum of 10 years before the project start date. The definition of forest may include mature forests, secondary forests, and degraded forests. Under the VCS Program, secondary forests are considered to be forests that have been cleared and have recovered naturally and that are at least 10-years-old and meet the lower bound of the forest threshold parameters at the start of the project. Forested wetlands, such as	The project area is composed of 100% native forest. The area is considered forest as per the definition of forest adopted by FAO ⁶ : Land spanning more than 0.5 hectares with trees higher than 5 meters and a canopy cover of more than 10%, or trees able to reach these thresholds <i>in situ</i> .

⁵ VERRA - AFOLU Non Permanence Risk Tool. Available at: <https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/08/AFOLU-Non-Permanence-Risk-Tool-v4.1.pdf>, v 4.1. Last access: 11/07/2023.

⁶ Comparative framework and Options for harmonisation of delimitations. Available at: [https://www.fao.org/3/y4171e/y4171e10.htm#:~:text=FAO%202000a%20\(FRA%202000%20Main,of%20other%20predomina](https://www.fao.org/3/y4171e/y4171e10.htm#:~:text=FAO%202000a%20(FRA%202000%20Main,of%20other%20predomina). Last access: 11/07/2023.

floodplain forests, peatland forests and mangrove forests, are also eligible provided they meet the forest definition requirements mentioned above.	
Activities covered under the REDD project category are those that are designed to stop planned (designated and sanctioned) deforestation or unplanned (unsanctioned) deforestation and/or degradation. Avoiding planned degradation is classified as IFM.	Project activity is designed to stop unplanned (unsanctioned) deforestation, as described throughout this PD draft document.
Activities that stop unsanctioned deforestation and/or illegal degradation (such as removal of fuelwood or timber extracted by non-concessionaires) on lands that are legally sanctioned for timber production are eligible as REDD activities. However, activities that reduce or stop logging only, followed by protection, on forest lands legally designated or sanctioned for forestry activities are included within IFM. Projects that include both avoided unplanned deforestation and/or degradation as well as stopping sanctioned logging activities, shall follow the REDD guidelines for the unplanned deforestation and/or degradation and the IFM guidelines for the sanctioned logging activities, and shall follow the requirements set out in Section 3.5.2.	In case future project activity instances have areas legally sanctioned for timber production, baseline and project activity shall comprehend unsanctioned deforestation and/or illegal degradation, not the reduction of logging.
Eligible REDD activities include: 1) Avoiding Planned Deforestation and/or Degradation (APDD): This category includes activities that reduce net GHG emissions by stopping or reducing deforestation or degradation on forest lands that are legally authorized and documented for conversion. 2) Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation and/or Degradation (AUDD): This category includes activities that reduce net GHG emissions by stopping deforestation and/or degradation of degraded to mature forests that would have occurred in any forest configuration.	The Evergreen II REDD+ project includes the activity Avoided Unplanned Deforestation (AUD).

1.4.3 Transfer project eligibility

Not applicable.

1.5 Project Design

☒ *Single location or installation*

☐ *Multiple locations or project activity instances (but not a grouped project)*

☐ *Grouped project*

1.5.1 Grouped project design

This is not a grouped project.

1.6 Project Proponent

Organization name	Ituxi Administração e Participação LTDA.
Contact person	Ricardo Villares Lot Stoppe
Title	Landowner and Project Developer
Address	723 Andrômeda Avenue, 22nd floor, room 2203, Air Offices, Green Valley, Alphaville Empresarial, Barueri-SP, 06473-000, Brazil
Telephone	+55 (11) 4382-7253
Email	projetoscarbono@grupoituxi.com

Organization name	Pau Brasil Assessoria Florestal
Contact person	Rômulo P. S. Arantes
Title	Project Developer
Address	673 Inácio Higino St, # 603, Vila Velha - ES, Brazil
Telephone	+55 (27) 99590-9090
Email	projetos@paubrasil.net.br

1.7 Other Entities Involved in the Project

There are no other entities involved in the project.

1.8 Ownership

The property “Fazenda Alvorada” (registration No. 224 CRI at the Registry Office of Apuí - Amazonas) is owned by Ituxi Administração e Participação LTDA. as per information in section 1.5. The legal documents proving the land title and ownership of the property (Environmental Registry for Rural Properties, Land Registry Certificate, Certificate from the Institute for Agrarian Reform) will be made available to the auditors during the validation process.

1.9 Project Start Date

Project start date	25-November-2020
Justification	The date the landowner signed the contract with the private security company to inspect the property to prevent deforestation and illegal hunting within its boundaries.

1.10 Project Crediting Period

Crediting period	☐ Seven years, twice renewable ☐ Ten years, fixed ☒ Other (state the selected crediting period and justify how it conforms with the VCS Program requirements)
Start and end date of first or fixed crediting period	25-November-2020 to 24-November-2050 According to Section 3.9.3 of the VCS Standard, v4.5, the project's initial crediting period shall be a minimum of 20 years and a maximum of 100 years and may be renewed a maximum of four times, with a total project crediting period not exceeding 100 years. Therefore, the project's crediting period is 30 years, starting on 25-November-2020 and ending on 24-November-2050.

1.11 Project Scale and Estimated GHG Emission Reductions or Removals

- ☒ < 300,000 tCO₂e/year (project)
☐ ≥ 300,000 tCO₂e/year (large project)

Calendar year of crediting period	Estimated GHG emission reductions or removals (tCO ₂ e)
25-november-2020 to 31-december-2020	3,871.55
01-january-2021 to 31-december-2021	282,535.05
01-january-2022 to 31-december-2022	276,096.04
01-january-2023 to 31-december-2023	269,803.78
01-january-2024 to 31-december-2024	263,654.92
01-january-2025 to 31-december-2025	257,646.19
01-january-2026 to 31-december-2026	251,774.41
01-january-2027 to 31-december-2027	246,036.44
01-january-2028 to 31-december-2028	240,429.24
01-january-2029 to 31-december-2029	234,949.83
01-january-2030 to 31-december-2030	229,595.3
01-january-2031 to 31-december-2031	224,362.79
01-january-2032 to 31-december-2032	219,249.54
01-january-2033 to 31-december-2033	214,252.82

Calendar year of crediting period	Estimated GHG emission reductions or removals (tCO ₂ e)
01-january-2034 to 31-december-2034	209,369.97
01-january-2035 to 31-december-2035	204,598.4
01-january-2036 to 31-december-2036	199,935.58
01-january-2037 to 31-december-2037	195,379.03
01-january-2038 to 31-december-2038	190,926.32
01-january-2039 to 31-december-2039	186,575.08
01-january-2040 to 31-december-2040	182,323.02
01-january-2041 to 31-december-2041	178,167.85
01-january-2042 to 31-december-2042	174,107.39
01-january-2043 to 31-december-2043	170,139.46
01-january-2044 to 31-december-2044	166,261.96
01-january-2045 to 31-december-2045	162,472.83
01-january-2046 to 31-december-2046	158,770.06
01-january-2047 to 31-december-2047	155,151.67
01-january-2048 to 31-december-2048	151,615.74
01-january-2049 to 31-december-2049	148,160.4
01-january-2050 to 24-november-2050	142,800.47

Calendar year of crediting period	Estimated GHG emission reductions or removals (tCO ₂ e)
Total estimated ERRs during the first or fixed crediting period	6,191,013.12
Total number of years	30
Average annual ERRs	206,367.10

1.12 Description of the Project Activity

The primary objective of the Evergreen II REDD+ project is to avoid unplanned deforestation (AUD) in an area of 36,989.62 hectares of Amazonian forest, equating to 6,191,013.12 tCO₂e in emissions reductions over the 30-year project lifetime (25-November-2020 to 24-November-2050), with an annual average of 206,367.10 tCO₂e.

The Project Proponents will adopt additional conservation measures: remote sense monitoring of changes in the land cover using satellite images, deforestation and heat spots monitoring, increasing surveillance hiring private security, and implementing a land, water, and air vigilance plan using quads, boats, drones and a plane, build security bases and provide internet signal to improve communication for illegal deforestation complaints.

Other social activities that benefit the local community will be supported, such as improving electricity infrastructure by solar photovoltaic panels, construction of groundwater wells, bioeconomy, and environmental education, improvement of rural roads and bridges, associations support, development the value chain of forest products and agriculture family production (nuts, oils, fish, fruits, legumes, and seeds). The CCB Standards is being considered to assess and monitor the project's contribution to sustainability, thus improving the social and environmental conditions in the project region.

The project is not located within a jurisdiction covered by a jurisdictional REDD+ program.

1.13 Project Location

The project area is situated in the municipality of Apuí, within the state of Amazonas, in northern Brazil. The project area spans 36,989.62 ha, located in the south of the Aripuanã River, at the “Fazenda Alvorada” farm.

The closest access road is BR-230, called Rodovia Transamazônica. This highway is one of the main federal roads in the country, connecting Cabedelo in Paraíba (western region of Brazil) with Lábrea in Amazonas, covering a total extension of over 4,000 km. This Rodovia crosses the municipality of Apuí.

The Evergreen II REDD+ project area overlaps three Conservation Units (or Protected Areas): Reserva de Desenvolvimento Sustentável Aripuanã, Floresta Estadual do Sucunduri and Floresta Nacional do Jatuarana. Despite the overlap, the project area is considered private property.

The location of the project, rivers, highways and protected areas are presented in Figure 01 below.

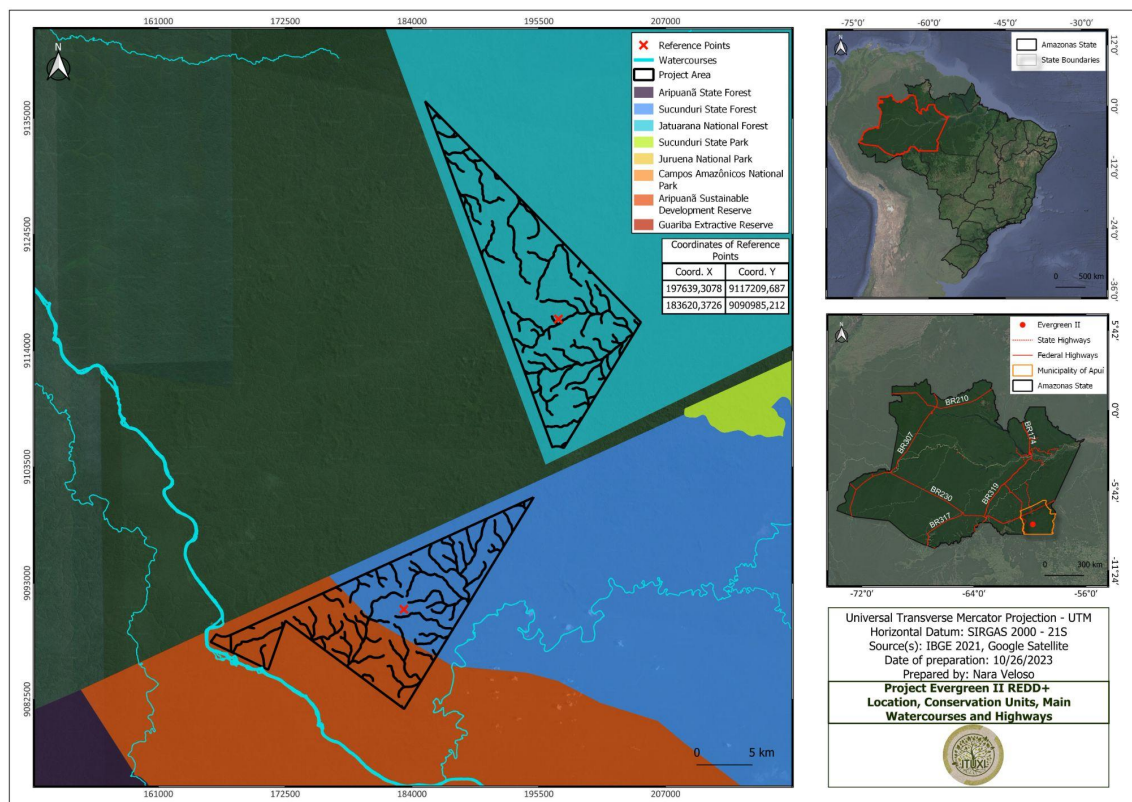


Figure 01. Project area, rivers, highways location and protected areas.

1.14 Conditions Prior to Project Initiation

The project has not been implemented to generate GHG emissions for the purpose of their subsequent reduction, removal, or destruction.

Ecosystem type

The terrestrial ecosystem present in the project area is composed 100% by Amazon Rainforest native vegetation. Forest terrestrial ecosystems, called "Terra firme" forests, are undoubtedly the most species rich vegetation type of the Amazon Rainforest biome⁷. The phytophysiognomies present in the project area are Dense Ombrophilous Forest and Open Ombrophilous Forest.

Current and historical land use

The property, where the project area is located, has a history of sustainable management practices. It is emphasised that over the last 10 years, the landscape has remained stable and natural without changes in land use and coverage. However, this pattern does not extend to the surrounding region, where the land use dynamics differ significantly. In 2022, Apuí was the municipality with the highest increase in deforestation (5.86%) among the Amazon's municipalities, reaching the mark of 731.72 km² of deforested area in one year.⁸ Several activities contribute to high rates of deforestation, such as agriculture, livestock, logging, and urbanization, with livestock farming being the main activity responsible for the current situation of Amazon forests.⁹

Climate

The climate of the Apuí region is warm and wet with a mild dry season. According to the classification of Köppen¹⁰, the climate in the region classified as "Am", a tropical zone with occurrence of monsoons. . Annual rainfall is approximately 2,200 mm/year, with the rainy season occurring from January to March and the dry period from June to August. Temperatures varying between 25 and 27°C and relative humidity between 85 and

⁷ BFG (the Brazil Flora Group). 2015. Growing knowledge: an overview of Seed Plant diversity in Brazil. Rodriguésia, v. 66, n. 4, p. 1085-1113. Available at: <https://www.scielo.br/j/rod/a/s8qy5ZLWZcyFxx9WGsh34PK/?lang=en>. Last access: 11/08/2023.

⁸ INPE. 2022. Instituto Nacional de Pesquisas Espaciais - Prodes project: Satellite Monitoring of the Amazon Available at: <http://http://terrabrasilis.dpi.inpe.br/app/dashboard/deforestation/biomes/amazon/increments>. Last access: 08/04/2023.

⁹ Margulis, S. 2003. Causas do Desmatamento da Amazônia Brasileira. Banco Mundial, Brasília: julho, 2003. Available at: <https://www.terrabrasilis.org.br/ecotecadigital/pdf/causas-do-desmatamento-da-amazonia-brasileira.pdf>. Last access: 11/08/2023.

¹⁰ Köppen, W. Das geographische System der Klimate, 1 – 44 (Gebrüder Borntraeger: Berlin, Germany, 1936). Available at: https://koeppen-geiger.vu-wien.ac.at/pdf/Koppen_1936.pdf. Last access: 11/08/2023.

90%¹¹, which is considered high. The Climate Koppen classification map is presented in Figure 02 below.

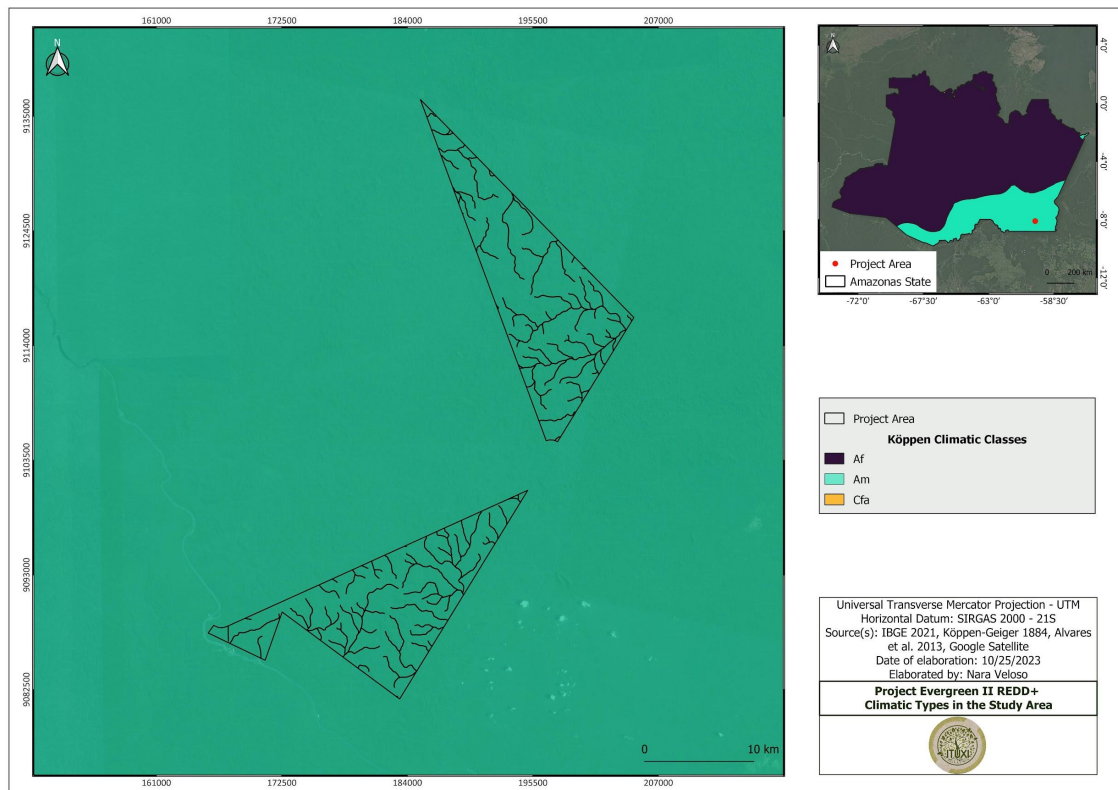


Figure 02. Climate Koppen classification map.

Hydrology, Topography, and Soils

The Amazon River basin is formed by the most extensive hydrographic network on the planet, occupying a total area of 6,110,000 km², from its sources in the Peruvian Andes to its mouth in the Atlantic Ocean. This basin is characterized by the Amazon River, its tributaries, and the floodplain lagoons that interact with the rivers. The Amazon Basin alone represents approximately 20% of all freshwater reserves in the world.

The municipality of Apuí is drained by the Sucunduri-Canumã River basin in the east and by the Aripuanã River in the west. The Juma River is considered the main watercourse of the municipality¹².

¹¹ Pavão, M. V. 2017. Impacto da Conversão da Cobertura Natural em Pastagem e Área Urbana sobre Variáveis Biofísicas no Sul do Amazonas. Revista Brasileira de Meteorologia, v 32, n.3, 343-351, 2017. Available at: <https://www.scielo.br/j/rbmet/a/K386zvC79vGrcLgggBvGqPf/?format=pdf&lang=pt>. Last access: 11/08/2023.

¹² Lages, A.S. 2010. Geochemistry of black water from rivers in the municipality of Apuí, Amazonas. Dissertation presented to the Graduate Program in Geosciences of the Federal University of Amazonas. Available at: <https://tede.ufam.edu.br/handle/tede/3270>. Last access: 09/29/2023.

The project area is near the banks of the Aripuanã River, which is considered one of the most important tributaries on the right bank of the Madeira River. This river stretches for more than 1,100 km from its mouth to its headwaters, close to the Juína municipality, in the Mato Grosso state¹³. Figure 03 below shows the hydrography within the project area.

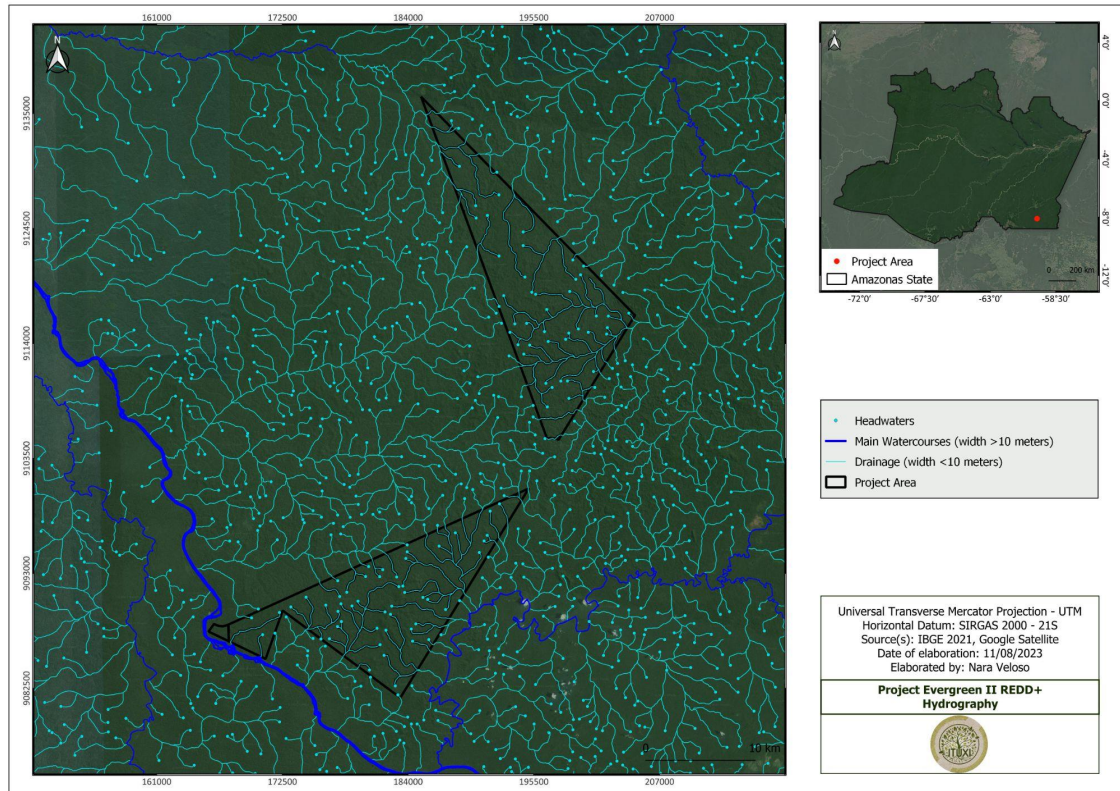


Figure 03. Hydrography within the project area.

The project is located in the Amazon river plain, whose topography was influenced by the accumulation of sediments from the Andes¹⁴. The elevation in the project region varies between 32 and 322 meters above sea level. The slope varies between less than 3 and more than 40%.

¹³Zawadzki, C. H; Carvalho, P. H. 2014. A new species of the *Hypostomus cochliodon* group (Siluriformes: Loricariidae) from the Rio Aripuanã basin in Brazil. Neotropical Ichthyology, 12(1):43-51. Available at: <https://www.scielo.br/j/ni/a/xDBtpK467gkNXpBw3FMXf9P/?lang=en>. Last access: 09/04/2023.

¹⁴Filizola, N., & Guyot, J. L. 2011. Fluxo de sedimentos em suspensão nos rios da Amazônia. Brazilian Journal of Geology, 41, 566-576. Available at: <https://www.scielo.br/bjgeo/a/H9RqgJd3FW6zhtYmpv3gnqd/>. Last access: 09/04/2023.

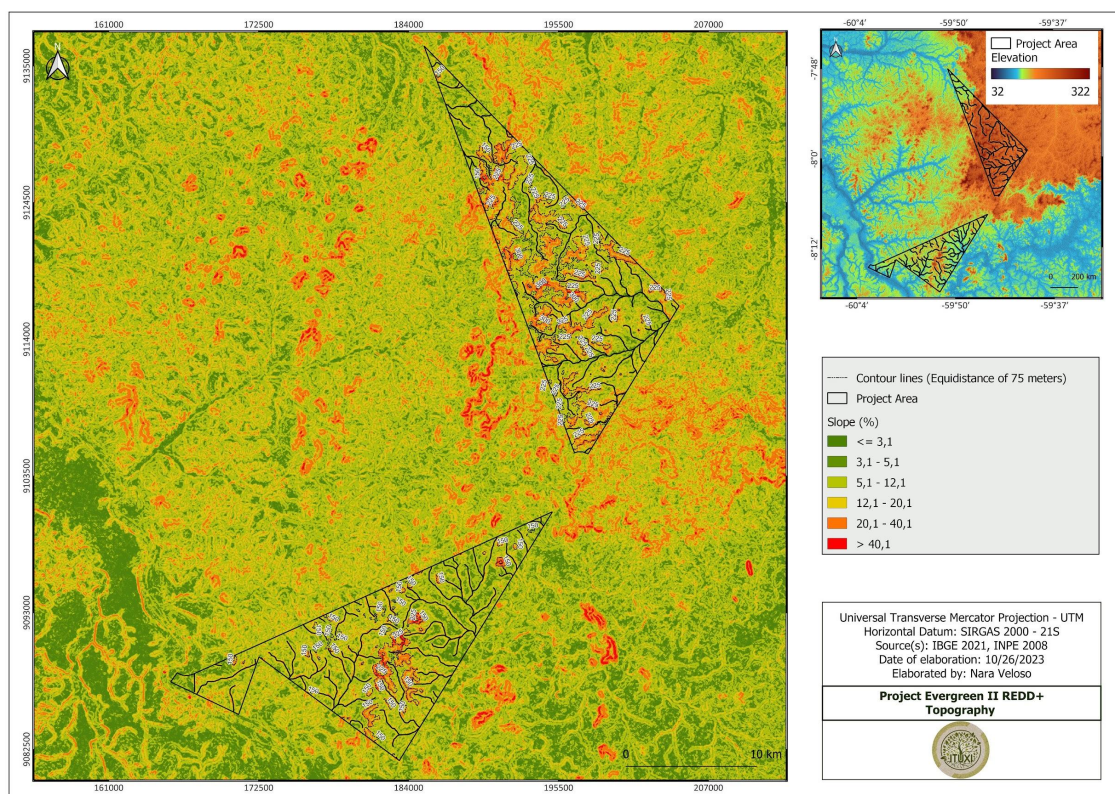


Figure 04. Topography within the project area.

The environmental conditions of the region promote the formation of Latosol and Argisol soil order, occurring in the following classes in the project area: yellow latosol, red-yellow argisol, and red-yellow latosol.¹⁵ The table below shows the soil order in the project area.

Soil class	Hectares	%
Yellow latosol	2,183.71	5.90%
Red-yellow argisol	30,221.55	81.70%
Red-yellow latosol	4,584.36	12.39%
TOTAL	36,989.62	100%

¹⁵ Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística. IBGE. 2021. Pedologia. 1: 250.000. Available at: <https://www.ibge.gov.br/geociencias/informacoes-ambientais/pedologia/10871-pedologia.html>. Last access: 11/08/2023.

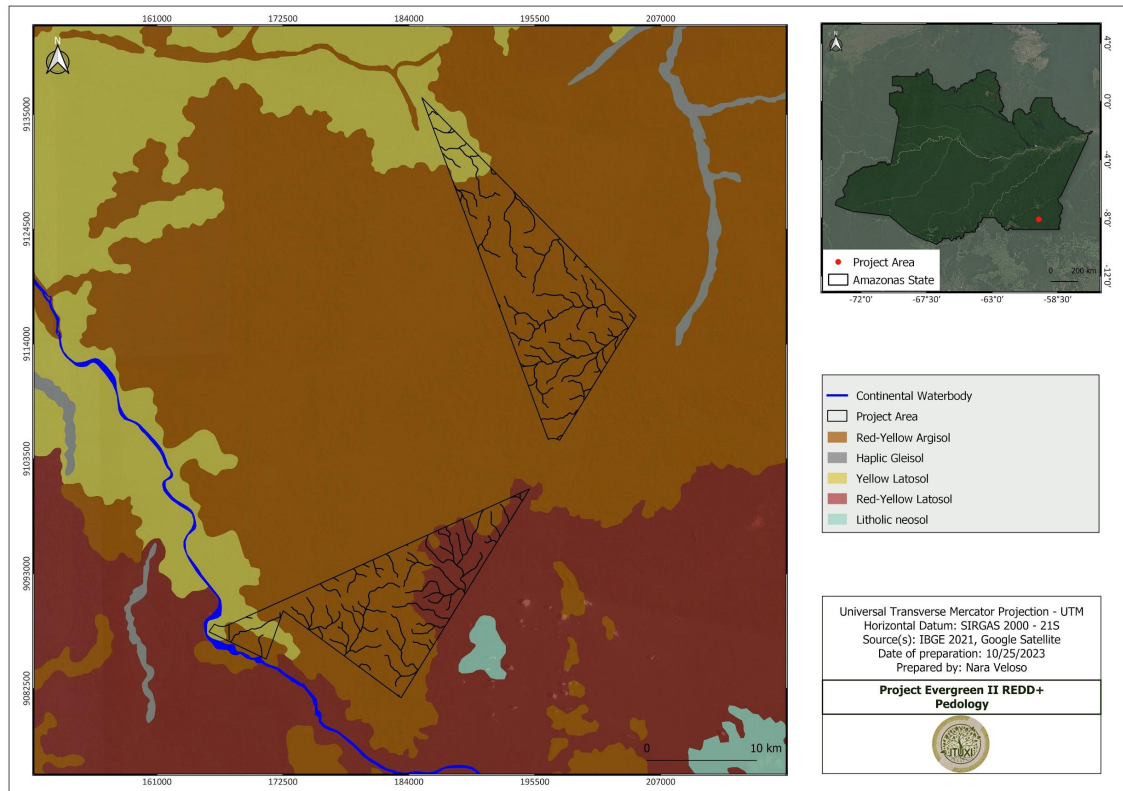


Figure 05. Soil types within the project area.

Relevant historic conditions

Over the years, the municipality of Apuí has been going through a process of transformation in land use and occupation, where forest areas have been deforested to establish mainly agriculture and pasture areas. Despite the increase in deforestation in the region, the project area remained with its vegetation cover preserved over the years. Land use and occupation of the project area and surroundings can be seen in Figure 06.

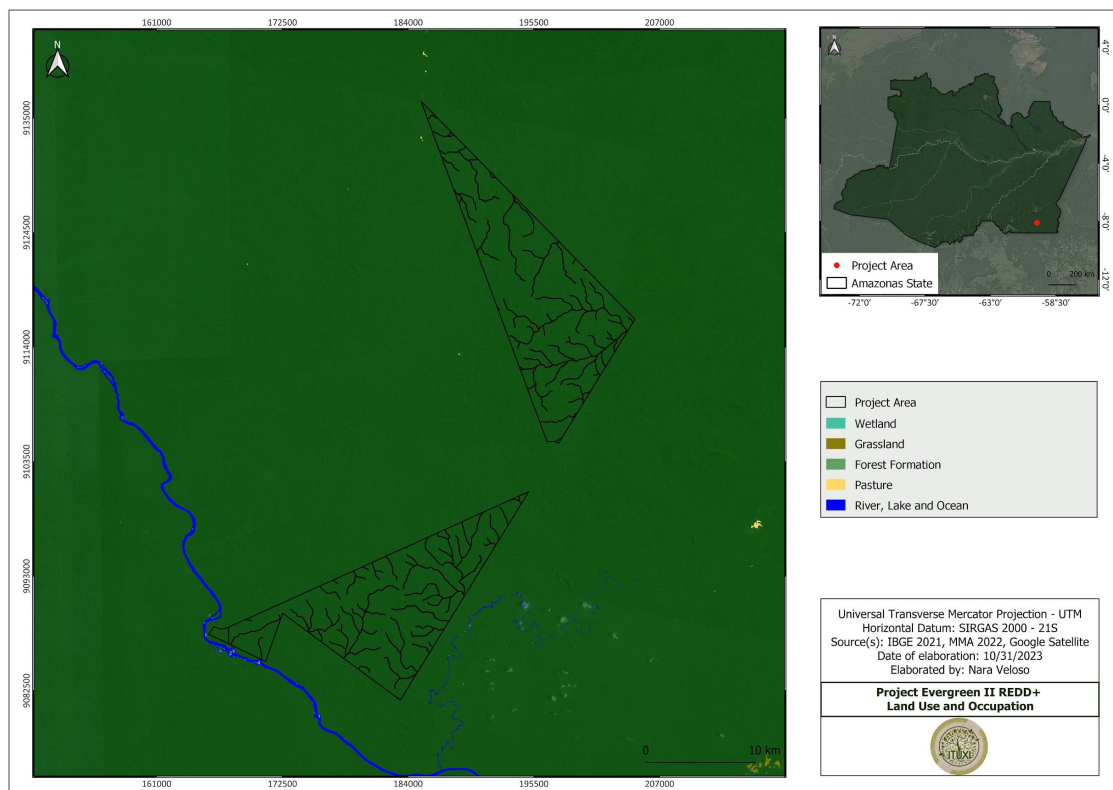


Figure 06. Land use and occupation of the project area and surrounding.

Vegetation and ecosystems

The project area is located in the Amazon Biome, and the most representative vegetation class in the area are the Submontane Dense Ombrophilous Forest and the Submontane Open Ombrophilous Forest, based on the Vegetation Map of Brazil (IBGE, 2021)¹⁶.

These phytophysiognomies are represented, in the project area, by the following floristic faciatis: Submontane Dense Ombrophilous Forest with emergent canopy; Submontane Open Ombrophilous with palms, and Submontane Open Ombrophilous Forest with lianas.

¹⁶ Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística – IBGE. 2021. Mapa de Vegetação do Brasil escala 1:250.000.

Available at:

https://www.ibge.gov.br/geociencias/informacoes-ambientais/vegetacao/22453-cartas-1-250-000.html?=&t=download_s. Last access: 08/07/2023.

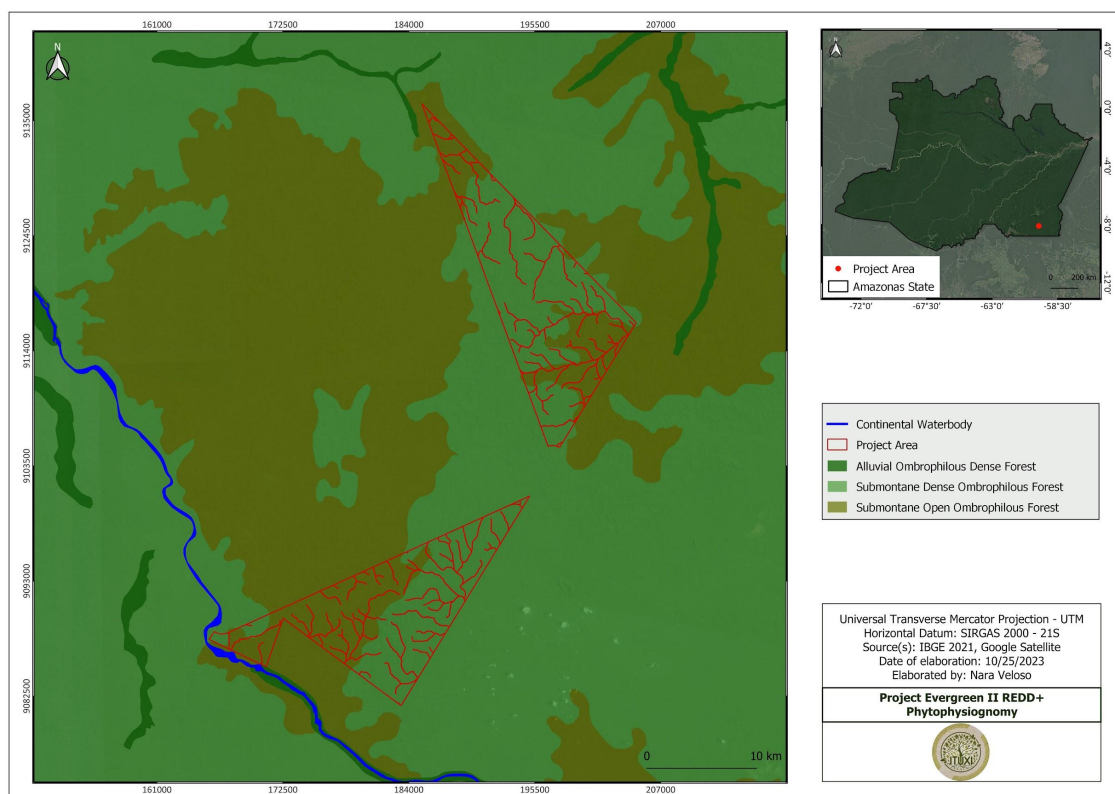


Figure 07. Vegetation cover in project region according to classification IBGE.

The table below presents the phytophysionomies in the project area, extension and the percentage of coverage.

Vegetation types	Hectares	%
Submontane Dense Ombrophilous Forest	24,032.00	35%
Submontane Open Ombrophilous Forest	12,957.62	65%
TOTAL	36,989.62	100%

Socioeconomic Conditions

The Evergreen II REDD+ project is situated in the municipality of Apuí, in the southern region of the state of Amazonas, forming part of the mesoregion of Southern Amazonas and the microregion of Madeira. The municipality has a territorial extension of 54,240 square kilometers with a population of approximately 20,647 inhabitants¹⁷, equating to a population

¹⁷ Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística. IBGE. Demographic Census 2022. Available at: <https://cidades.ibge.gov.br/brasil/am/apui/panorama>. Last access: 10/30/2023.

density of 0.38 individuals per square kilometer, a proportion below the state average. Apuí borders the state of Mato Grosso to the south, and to the east with Mato Grosso and Pará, to the west with the municipality of Novo Aripuanã, and to the north with the municipalities of Borba and Maués.

Considering the data from the 2010 Census, Apuí's HDI (Human Development Index) is medium (0.637)¹⁸. The most sensitive aspects for the index result pertain to education (0.540), classified as low, followed by income (0.621), categorized as moderate, and longevity (0.772), the only component of the index with a high result. In the reference¹⁹, this year, the schooling rate of its inhabitants between 6 and 14 years old was just over 93,4%, one of the lowest rates among all municipalities in the country.

Regarding health, in 2020²⁰, the average infant mortality rate in the city was 11.32 deaths per thousand live births, the 46th highest rate in the state. Low sanitation rates stand out as a critical point in the municipality. Within the population, about 88% had no sewage collected or treated, while less than 1% had sewage collection, but without treatment²¹. The remaining 11% of the population resort to individual solutions for domestic sewage.

In 2020, Apuí's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) reached the mark of R\$ 272,114,030. When divided by the number of inhabitants in its territory, this value would correspond to R\$12,170.22²² per person, placing it in the 4,105th position compared to other Brazilian municipalities²³. The sectors that contributed the most to the municipal GDP in 2020 were, respectively: public administration, defense, education, and public health and social security (39,78%), agriculture (27,74%), and services - excluding administration, defense, education, public health, and social security (24,92%)²⁴.

¹⁸PNUD. Atlas do Desenvolvimento Humano. Available at: <http://www.atlasbrasil.org.br/consulta/planilha>. Last access: 10/30/2023.

¹⁹Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística. IBGE. Available at: <https://www.ibge.gov.br/cidades-e-estados/am/apui.html>. Last access: 10/30/2023.

²⁰Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística. IBGE. Available at: <https://www.ibge.gov.br/cidades-e-estados/am/apui.html>. Last access: 10/30/2023.

²¹Agência Nacional de Águas (ANA). Atlas esgotos. Available at: <https://app.powerbi.com/view?r=eyJrIjoiZjA1ZjQwZWUuYmRkYS00YjM0LWFhMjltMTMyOTQ0NDljNGQyIiwidCI6ImUwYmI0MDEyLTQxMGItNDY5YS04YjRkLTkyN2ZjZDFiYWY4OCJ9>. Last access: 10/31/2023.

²²Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística. IBGE Available at: <https://www.ibge.gov.br/estatisticas/economicas/contas-nacionais/9088-produto-interno-bruto-dos-municipios.html?t=pib-por-municipio&c=1300144>. Last access: 10/30/2023.

²³Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística. IBGE Available at: <https://cidades.ibge.gov.br/brasil/am/apui/panorama>. Last access: 10/30/2023.

²⁴Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística. IBGE. Available at: <https://www.ibge.gov.br/estatisticas/economicas/contas-nacionais/9088-produto-interno-bruto-dos-municipios.html?t=pib-por-municipio&c=1300144>. Last access: 10/30/2023.

The income concentration among the economic classes in Apuí is relatively higher than the state average. Lower purchasing power brackets (E and D) account for 70,3% of the city's total remuneration, while higher classes represent 1,9%. Apuí's Gini index is 0.56 (moderate/high)²⁵.

In 2022, most of Apuí's territory was covered by forests (88%), followed by areas used for agriculture and livestock (9%), mainly pastures²⁶. The urban area represented less than 1% of the total area of the municipality. The expansion of large-scale livestock farming has contributed to pressure on the forest, leading to the creation of new pastures, including in permanent preservation areas.

1.15 Compliance with Laws, Statutes and Other Regulatory Frameworks

The proponents of the Evergreen II REDD+ project undertake to comply with applicable and relevant national, state and local laws, including statutes and regulatory frameworks.

REGIONAL LEGAL NORMS

Decree No. 32.986/2012 - Forest replanting in the state of Amazonas;

Decree No. 10.028/1987 - State System for Licensing Activities with Potential Impact on the Environment and Application of Penalties and other provisions;

Law No. 3.785/2012 - Environmental licensing in the state of Amazonas;

Law No. 2.407/1996 - State System for the Environment, Science and Technology;

Law 2.416/1996 - Granting of licenses for the exploitation, processing and industrialization of forest products and by-products for timber purposes and other provisions;

Law No. 2.984/2005 - Policy for the Prevention and Control of Pollution, Improvement and Recovery of the Environment and Protection of Natural Resources and other provisions;

Law No. 2.985/2005 - Amazonas State Environmental Council - CEMAAM;

Law 3.135/2007 - Amazonas State Policy on Climate Change, Environmental Conservation and Sustainable Development;

Law 3.244/2008 - Management Unit of the State Center for Climate Change and the State Center for Conservation Units (UGMUC);

²⁵ PNUD. Atlas do Desenvolvimento Humano. Available at: <http://www.atlasbrasil.org.br/perfil/municipio/130014#sec-renda>. Last access: 30/10/2023.

²⁶ MAPBIOMAS. Plataforma Uso e Cobertura do Solo. Available at <<https://mapbiomas.org/>>. Last access: 10/31/2023.

Law 3.262/2008 - Strategic Group to Combat Environmental Crimes (GECAM);

Law No. 3.245/2008 - Artisanal production of edible products of animal origin and their sale in the state of Amazonas;

Law No. 3.417/2009 - Ecological-Economic Macro zoning of the State of Amazonas (MZEE);

Law No. 3.645/2011 - Ecological-Economic Zoning (ZEE) of the Purus Sub-Region in the State of Amazonas, establishes guidelines for land use and occupation;

Law No. 3.785/2012 - Environmental licensing in the state of Amazonas;

Law No. 3.789/2012 - Forest replanting in the state of Amazonas;

Law No. 3.800/2012 - General Policy for Rural Production in the State of Amazonas;

Law No. 3.801/2012 - Amazonas State Agricultural and Forestry Defense Agency (ADAF);

Law No. 4.185/2015 - Environmental licensing in the state of Amazonas, the responsibility of the Amazonas Environmental Protection Institute (IPAAM);

Law No. 4.266/2015 - Amazonas State Policy on Environmental Services and the Environmental Services Management System, creates the State Fund for Climate Change, Environmental Conservation and Environmental Services;

Law No. 4.406/2016 - State Environmental Regularization Policy, provides for the Rural Environmental Registry (CAR), the Rural Environmental Registry System (SICAR-AM), the Environmental Regularization Program (PRA), in the State of Amazonas;

Law No. 4,419/2016 - Environmental Economic Policy of the State of Amazonas for Sustainable Development, called the Amazonas Economic-Environmental Matrix;

Law No. 4.505/2017 - Protection of springs, waterholes and natural vegetation in their surroundings;

CERH Resolution No. 01/2016 - Analysis of applications for granting the right to use water resources in the State of Amazonas;

CERH Resolution No. 01/2017 - Analysis of applications for granting the right to use water resources under the domain of the State of Amazonas;

RESOLUTION/CEMAAM/No. 011/2012 - Procedures to be observed in environmental licensing for gold mining activities in the state of Amazonas.

NATIONAL LEGAL NORMS

Law 14.119/2021 - National Policy for Payment for Environmental Services;

Law No. 12.727/2012 - Protection of native vegetation;

Law No. 9.985/2000 - National Conservation Units System;

Law No. 12.651/2012 - Protection of native vegetation, Forest Code;

Law No. 12.187/2009 - National Policy on Climate Change (PNMC);

Decree No. 11.075/2022 - Sectoral Climate Change Mitigation Plans and the National System for Reducing Greenhouse Gas Emissions;

Decree No. 10.144/2019 - National Commission for the Reduction of Greenhouse Gas Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation, Conservation of Forest Carbon Stocks, Sustainable Forest Management and Increase of Forest Carbon Stocks - REDD+ (CONAREDD+);

Decree 58.054/1966 - Convention for the Protection of the Flora, Fauna and Scenic Beauties of the Americas;

Decree No. 2.661/1998 - Precautionary rules regarding the use of fire in agricultural and forestry practices, and other provisions;

Decree No. 5.975/2006 - Regulates articles 12, final part, 15, 16, 19, 20 and 21 of Law No. 4.771, of September 15, 1965, article 4, item III, of Law No. 6.938, of August 31, 1981, article 2 of Law No. 10.650, of April 16, 2003, amends and adds provisions to Decrees Nos. 6.514/08 and 3.420/00, and other provisions;

CONAMA Resolution 16/1989 - Establishes the Integrated Program for Environmental Assessment and Control in the Legal Amazon;

CONAMA Resolution No. 378/2006 - Defines projects that potentially cause national or regional environmental impact;

CONAMA Resolution No. 379/2006 - Data and information system on forest management within the National Environmental System (SISNAMA);

MMA Ordinance 103/2006 - Forest Origin Document (DOF);

MMA Ordinance No. 253/2006 - Document of Forest Origin (DOF) to replace the Authorization for the Transport of Forest Products (ATPF);

MMA Normative Instruction 01/1996 - Compulsory Forest Replacement and the Integrated Forestry Plan;

MMA Normative Instruction 07/1999 - Authorization for deforestation in the states of the Legal Amazon;

MMA Normative Instruction No. 02/2001 - Economic exploitation of forests on rural properties located in the Legal Amazon, including Legal Reserve areas and with the exception of permanent preservation areas established in current legislation, which will be carried out through sustainable forest management practices for multiple use;

MMA Normative Instruction No. 06/2006 - Forest replenishment and the consumption of forest raw materials;

IBAMA Normative Instruction No. 178/2008 - Issuance of authorizations to suppress forests and other forms of native vegetation in areas larger than two thousand hectares on rural properties located in the Legal Amazon;

IBAMA Ordinance No. 438/1989 - Changes the wording of Article 4 of Ordinance No. 218/1989;

Regulatory Standard No. 31/2005 - Regulatory Standard for Safety and Health at Work in Agriculture, Livestock, Forestry, Logging and Aquaculture;

Federal Constitution of 1988 - Art. 225 right to a balanced environment and Art. 215. Right to cultural appreciation;

Law 10.406/2002 - Civil Code:

- Art. 1245 "Property is transferred between living persons by registering the transferable title in the Real Estate Registry".

- Art. 1.238. Anyone who, for fifteen years, without interruption or opposition, possesses a property as their own, acquires ownership of it, regardless of title and good faith; they may ask the judge to declare this by judgment, which will serve as a title for registration with the Real Estate Registry Office.

- Art. 1.242: Property is also acquired by those who, continuously and undisputedly, with just title and good faith, have owned it for ten years;

Law 13.105/2015 - Code of Civil Procedure;

Law 6.001/1973 - Indigenous Statute;

Decree 6.040/2007 - National Policy for the Sustainable Development of Traditional Peoples and Communities;

Decree-Law No. 5.452/1943 - Consolidation of Labor Laws (CLT);

Law 5.889/1973 - Regulatory Standards for Rural Work.

INTERNATIONAL LEGAL NORMS

Convention on Biological Diversity (1992) in Rio de Janeiro (ECO-92);

Report reducing emissions from deforestation in developing countries - Report COP 11, Montreal, 2005 (FCCC/CP/2005/Misc.1);

International Tropical Timber Agreement (2006), signed by the Federative Republic of Brazil in Geneva on January 27, 2006;

Declaration of the Rights of Indigenous Peoples and their Rights at the International Level (2007), promulgated in 2007 in New York;

Report Part Two: Action taken "Bali Action Plan" - Report COP 13, Bali, 2007; (FCCC/CP/2007/6/add.1);

Copenhagen Accord - Report COP 15, Copenhagen, 2009 (FCCC/CP/2009/Add.1);

Report Part Two: Action taken "Cancun Agreement" - Report COP 16, Cancun, 2010 (FCCC/CP/2010/7/Add.1);

Report Part Two: Action taken "Durban Action Plan" - Report COP 17, Durban, 2011 (FCCC/CP/2011/9/Add.1);

Report Part Two - Report COP 18, Doha, 2012 (FCCC/CP/2012/8/Add.1);

Warsaw REDD+ Package - Report COP 19 2013, (FCCC/CP/2013/Add.1) in particular the following decisions:

Work program on results-based financing to progress the full implementation of the activities referred to in decision 1/CP.16, paragraph 70.) (Decision 9/CP.19);

Coordination of support for the implementation of activities related to mitigation actions in the forest sector by developing countries, including institutional arrangements). (Decision 10/CP.19)

The timing and frequency with which summary information is presented on how all safeguards referred to in Decision1/CP.16, Appendix I, are being addressed and respected) (Decision 12/CP.19);

Guidance and procedures for the technical assessment of Parties' submissions on proposals for forest reference emission levels and/or forest reference levels) (Decision 13/CP.19);

Modalities for measuring, reporting and verifying (Decision 14/CP.19);

Addressing the drivers of deforestation and forest degradation (Decision15/CP.19);

Report Part Two: Report COP 21, Paris, 2015 (FCCC/CP/2015/Add.1);

Global and legally binding agreement establishing a global framework to avoid dangerous climate change by limiting global warming to well below 2°C and pursuing efforts to limit it to 1.5°C. Entry into force on November 4, 2016 (Paris Agreement FCCC/CP/2015);

Decisions 1 (Preparing for the entry into force of the Paris Agreement), 3 (Warsaw International Mechanism for Loss and Damage associated with the Impacts of Climate Change), 6 (National adaptation plans) and 7 (Long-term financing of the fight against climate change) - COP 22 Report, Marrakech, 2016 (FCCC/CP/2016);

Especially decision 1 which reports on the progress of the implementation of the Paris Agreement (FCCC/CP/2017, FCCC/CP/2018, FCCC/CP/2019 - Decisions adopted by the COP);

Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC): Brazilian NDC submitted to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change for Mitigation (2015), adaptation and means of implementation, in a manner consistent with the purpose of the contributions to achieve the ultimate objective of the Convention, under the terms of decision 1/CP.20, paragraph 9 with update presented at COP26 in 2022;

CITES, of 03/03/1973: "Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora", signed in Washington D.C. (1973) and amended in Bonn (1979);

Article 6 of the Paris Agreement (2021): Decision 1/CP.21 mandated SBSTA to operationalize the provisions of this article by recommending a set of decisions to the COP that serves as the meeting of the Parties to the Paris Agreement at its first session. At COP26, the Parties to the Paris Agreement, at their third session (CMA 3), adopted three main decisions related to Article 6: decision 2 (on Article 6.2), decision 3 (on Article 6.4) and decision 4 (on Article 6.8);

Glasgow Leaders' Declaration on Forests and Land Use (2021): The signatories (including Brazil) promise to reverse and end deforestation by 2030.

1.16 Double Counting and Participation under Other GHG Programs

1.16.1 No Double Issuance

Is the project receiving or seeking credit for reductions and removals from a project activity under another GHG program?

☐ Yes

☒ No

1.16.2 Registration in Other GHG Programs

Is the project registered or seeking registration under any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.16.3 Projects Rejected by Other GHG Programs

Has the project been rejected by any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17 Double Claiming, Other Forms of Credit, and Scope 3 Emissions

1.17.1 No Double Claiming with Emissions Trading Programs or Binding Emission Limits

Are project reductions and removals or project activities also included in an emissions trading program or binding emission limit? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definitions of emissions trading program and binding emission limit.

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17.2 No Double Claiming with Other Forms of Environmental Credit

Has the project activity sought, received, or is planning to receive credit from another GHG-related environmental credit system? See the VCS Program Definitions for definition of GHG-related environmental credit system.

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17.3 Supply Chain (Scope 3) Emissions

Do the project activities specified in Section 1.12 affect the emissions footprint of any product(s) (goods or services) that are part of a supply chain?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.18 Sustainable Development Contributions

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

1.19 Additional Information Relevant to the Project

1.19.1 Leakage Management

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

1.19.2 Commercially Sensitive Information

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

1.19.3 Further Information

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2 SAFEGUARDS AND STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT

2.1 Stakeholder Engagement and Consultation

2.1.1 Stakeholder Identification

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.1.2 Stakeholder Consultation and Ongoing Communication

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.1.3 Free Prior and Informed Consent

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.1.4 Grievance Redress Procedure

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.1.5 Public Comments

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.2 Risks to Stakeholders and the Environment

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.3 Respect for Human Rights and Equity

2.3.1 Labor and Work

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.3.2 Human Rights

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.3.3 Indigenous Peoples and Cultural Heritage

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.3.4 Property Rights

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.3.5 Benefit Sharing

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.4 Ecosystem Health

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.4.1 Rare, Threatened, and Endangered species

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.4.2 Introduction of species

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

2.4.3 Ecosystem conversion

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

3 APPLICATION OF METHODOLOGY

3.1 Title and Reference of Methodology

The Evergreen II REDD+ project is applying to the Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) with the intention to reduce CO₂ emissions from unplanned deforestation (AUD) compared to the baseline levels. As required by VM0007, the project area consists of contiguous and discrete areas covered by forests that meet the definition of eligible forest, which would be an area that has been forested for at least 10 years prior to the project start date.

The list below refers to the methodologies, modules, and tools used in this project scope.

Type (methodology, tool or module).	Reference ID, if applicable	Title	Version
Methodology	VM0007	VM0007 REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD+MF) ²⁷	1.6
Module	VMD0001	VMD0001 “Estimation of carbon stocks in the above and belowground biomass in live tree and non tree pools” (CP-AB) ²⁸	1.1
Module	VMD0005	VMD0005 “Estimation of carbon stocks in the long-term wood products pool” (CP-W) ²⁹	1.1
Module	VMD0007	VMD0007 “Estimation of baseline carbon stock changes and greenhouse gas emissions from unplanned deforestation and unplanned wetland degradation” (BL UP) ³⁰	3.3
Module	VMD0010	VMD0010 “Estimation of emissions from activity shifting for avoiding unplanned deforestation and avoiding unplanned wetland degradation (LK-ASU) ³¹	1.2

²⁷ VERRA – VM0007 REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD+MF), v1.6. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodology/vm0007-redd-methodology-framework-redd-mf-v1-6/> . Last access: 10/30/2023.

²⁸ VERRA - VMD0001 Estimation of carbon stocks in the above and belowground biomass in live tree and non tree pools (CP-AB), v 1.1. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0001-estimation-of-carbon-stocks-in-the-above-and-belowground-biomass-in-live-tree-and-non-tree-pools-cp-ab-v1-1/>. Last access: 10/30/2023

²⁹ VERRA - VMD0005 Estimation of carbon stocks in the long-term wood products pool (CP-W), v 1.1. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0005-estimation-carbon-stocks-long-term-wood-products-pool-cp-w-v1-1/> Last access: 10/30/2023

³⁰ VERRA - VMD0007 Estimation of baseline carbon stock changes and greenhouse gas emissions from unplanned deforestation and unplanned wetland degradation (BL UP), v 3.3. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0007-estimation-of-baseline-carbon-stock-changes-and-greenhouse-gas-emissions-from-unplanned-deforestation-bl-up-v3-3/>. Last access: 10/30/2023

³¹ VERRA - VMD0010 Estimation of emissions from activity shifting for avoiding unplanned deforestation and avoiding unplanned wetland degradation (LK-ASU), v 1.2. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0010-estimation-of-emissions-from-activity-shifting-for-avoided-unplanned-deforestation-lk-asu-v1-2/>. Last access: 10/30/2023

Module	VMD0011	VMD0011 “Estimation of emissions from market effects” (LK-ME)” ³²	1.1
Module	VMD0013	VMD0013 “Estimation of greenhouse gas emissions from biomass and peat burning (E-BPB)” ³³	1.2
Module	VMD0014	VMD0014 “Estimation of emissions from fossil fuel combustion (E-FFC)” ³⁴	1.0
Module	VMD0015	VMD0015 “Methods for monitoring of GHG emissions and removals in REDD and CIW projects (M-REDD)” ³⁵	2.2
Module	VMD0016	VMD0016 “Methods for stratification of the project area (X-STR)” ³⁶	1.2
Module	VMD0017	VMD0017 “Estimation of uncertainty for REDD project activities (X-UNC)” ³⁷	2.2
Tool	VT0001	VT0001 “Tool for the demonstration and assessment of additionality in VCS	3.0

³² VERRA - VMD0011 Estimation of emissions from market effects (LK-ME), v 1.1. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0011-estimation-of-emissions-from-market-effects-lk-me-v1-1/>. Last access: 10/30/2023

³³ VERRA - VMD0013 Estimation of greenhouse gas emissions from biomass and peat burning (E-BPB), v 1.2. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0013-estimation-of-greenhouse-gas-emissions-from-biomass-and-peat-burning-e-bpb-v1-2/>. Last access: 10/30/2023

³⁴ VERRA - VMD0014 Estimation of emissions from fossil fuel combustion (E-FFC), v 1.0. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0014-estimation-of-emissions-from-fossil-fuel-combustion-e-ffc-v1-0/>. Last access: 10/30/2023

³⁵ VERRA - VMD0015 Methods for monitoring of GHG emissions and removals in REDD and CIW projects (M-REDD), v 2.2. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0015-methods-for-monitoring-of-greenhouse-gas-emissions-and-removals-m-redd-v2-2/>. Last access: 10/30/2023

³⁶ VERRA - VMD0016 “Methods for stratification of the project area (X-STR), v 1.2. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0016-methods-for-stratification-of-the-project-area-x-str-v1-2/>. Last access: 10/30/2023

³⁷ VERRA - VMD0017 “Estimation of uncertainty for REDD project activities (X-UNC), v 2.2. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0017-estimation-of-uncertainty-for-redd-project-activities-x-unc-v2-2/>. Last access: 10/30/2023

		agriculture, Forestry And Other Land Use (AFOLU) project activities” ³⁸	
Tool		CDM “Combined tool to identify the baseline scenario and demonstrate additionality in A/R CDM project activities (T-ADD)” ³⁹	01
Tool		CDM “Executive Board “Tool for testing significance of GHG emissions in A/R CDM project activities” ⁴⁰	01
Tool	-	AFOLU “Non Permanence Risk Tool” ⁴¹	4.1

³⁸ VERRA - VT0001 “Tool for the demonstration and assessment of additionality in VCS agriculture, Forestry And Other Land Use (AFOLU) project activities, v 3.0. Available at: <https://verra.org/methodologies/vt0001-tool-for-the-demonstration-and-assessment-of-additionality-in-vcs-agriculture-forestry-and-other-land-use-afolu-project-activities-v3-0/>. Last access: 10/30/2023

³⁹CDM - Combined tool to identify the baseline scenario and demonstrate additionality in A/R CDM project activities (T-ADD), v 01. Available at: <https://cdm.unfccc.int/methodologies/ARmethodologies/tools/ar-am-tool-02-v1.pdf>. Last access: 10/30/2023

⁴⁰ CDM - Executive Board “Tool for testing significance of GHG emissions in A/R CDM project activities, v 01. Available at: <https://cdm.unfccc.int/methodologies/ARmethodologies/tools/ar-am-tool-04-v1.pdf>. Last access: 10/30/2023

⁴¹ VERRA - AFOLU Non Permanence Risk Tool. Available at: <https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/08/AFOLU-Non-Permanence-Risk-Tool-v4.1.pdf>, v 4.1. Last access: 10/30/2023

3.2 Applicability of Methodology

Methodology ID	Applicability Conditions	Justification of compliance
VM0007: All Project Activities	All land areas registered under the CDM or under any other GHG program (both voluntary and compliance oriented) must be transparently reported and excluded from the project area. The exclusion of land in the project area from any other GHG program must be monitored over time and reported in the monitoring reports.	The project area does not have any area registered as CDM or any other GHG program (voluntary or compliance). Therefore, there is no exclusion of areas
VM0007: All REDD Activity Types	Land in the project area has qualified as forest (following the definition used by VCS) for at least 10 years before the project start date.	The project area is qualified and meets the condition, with the ecosystem functioning as a forest in the period between 2010 and 2020 for AUD category.
	If land within the project area is peatland or tidal wetlands and emissions from the SOC pool are deemed significant, the relevant WRC modules must be applied alongside other relevant modules.	Not applicable. The area is not a peatland or tidal wetland. As can be seen in Figure 4, indicating that there is no presence of organic soils. Source: IBGE/BDIA. ⁴²

⁴² IBGE - Available in: Brazilian Institute of Geography and Statistics, 2021. <https://www.ibge.gov.br/geociencias/informacoes-ambientais/pedologia/10871-pedologia.html>. Last access: 10/30/2023

VM0007: Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation	Baseline deforestation and forest degradation in the project area fall within one or more of the following categories: • Unplanned deforestation (VCS category AUD);	The baseline deforestation and forest degradation in the project area fall within the Category Unplanned deforestation (AUD category).
	Leakage avoidance activities must not include: • Agricultural lands that are flooded to increase production (e.g., rice paddy); • Intensifying livestock production using feedlots and/or manure lagoons.	Leakage avoidance activities do not include flooding agricultural land or creating feed-lots or manure lagoons. Such activities are not common in the project region.
	Baseline agents of deforestation must: (i) clear the land for tree harvesting, settlements, crop production (agriculturalist) or ranching or aquaculture, where such clearing for crop production or ranching or aquaculture does not amount to large scale industrial agriculture or aquaculture activities; (ii) have no documented and uncontested legal right to deforest the land for these purposes; and (iii) be either resident in the reference region for deforestation or immigrants. Under any other condition, this methodology must not be used.	(i) The baseline drivers of deforestation are small-scale farmers, who convert land to small-scale crops and pasture production. (ii) The agents of deforestation, according to geospatial data, have no right to deforest the land, since land use in protected areas is not allowed, as Permanent Protection Areas and Legal Reserve; (ii) The agents of deforestation are local residents in the reference region.

	If in the baseline scenario of avoiding unplanned deforestation project activities, post-deforestation land use constitutes reforestation, this methodology may not be used	Within the area of the project, the post-deforestation land use constitutes livestock and agriculture. Reforestation does not constitute post-deforestation land use of the project. According to geospatial images and land use and change analysis, reforestation is not a common practice in Brazilian land use economics.
VMD0001 CP-AB	This module is applicable to all forest types and age classes.	The module is applicable to the uneven-aged forest types of the project.
	Inclusion of the aboveground tree biomass pool as part of the project boundary is mandatory as per the framework module REDD-MF.	The aboveground tree biomass pool is included, being the most significant pool.
	Non-tree aboveground biomass must be included as part of the project boundary if the following applicability criteria are met (per framework module REDD-MF): Stocks of non-tree aboveground biomass are greater in the baseline than in the project scenario; Non-tree aboveground biomass is determined to be significant (using the T-SIG module).	Above-ground non-tree biomass was included when it was determined to be significant (using the T-SIG module).

	Belowground (tree and non-tree) biomass are not required for inclusion in the project boundary because omission is conservative.	Belowground (tree and non-tree) biomass is included, when it is determined to be significant (using the T-SIG module).
	This module is applicable to all forest types and age classes.	The module is applicable to the uneven-aged forest types of the project.
	This module is applicable if the dead wood pool is included as part of the project boundary.	This pool is excluded when it does not represent a significant component of the forest biomass.
VMD0007 BL-UP	The module must be applied to all project activities where the baseline agents of deforestation: (i) clear the land for settlements, crop production (agriculturalist), ranching, or aquaculture, where such clearing for crop production, ranching, or aquaculture does not amount to large-scale industrial Agri/aquaculture activities; (ii) have no documented and uncontested legal right to deforest the land for these purposes; and (iii) are either resident in the region or immigrants.	In the baseline scenario, deforestation agents convert land to livestock and small-scale agricultural production, where there is no legal right to clear the land for these purposes; agents are local residents of the region or immigrants seeking land for land use as pasture.
	Where pre-project, unsustainable fuelwood collection is occurring within the project boundaries, Modules BL-DFW and	Unsustainable fuelwood collection was not identified within the project boundary in the initial consultations with stakeholders in the project

	LK-DFW must be used to determine potential leakage.	activity. This will be verified on monitoring occasions.
VMD0010 LK-ASU	This Module is applicable for estimating carbon stock changes and greenhouse gas emissions related to the displacement of activities that cause deforestation of lands outside the project area due to the avoided unplanned deforestation in the project area. Activities subject to potential displacement are the conversion of forest land to grazing lands, crop lands, and other land uses.	The activities of the project involve avoiding unplanned deforestation (AUD), so the displacement of these activities should be monitored, since the pressure for deforestation in the project area includes the conversion of forest land into grazing lands and crop lands.
	The module is mandatory if module BL-UP has been used to define the baseline and the applicability conditions in module BL-UP must be complied with in full.	The BL-UP module is applied to the project and meets the established applicability conditions.

VMD0011 LK-ME	This module is applicable for calculating market-effects leakage from REDD projects that are anticipated to reduce levels of wood harvest substantially and permanently. When REDD project activities result in reductions in wood harvest, it is likely that production could shift to other areas of the country to compensate for the reduction. As referenced in the Framework (REDD-MF) the module is mandatory where: • The process of deforestation involves timber harvesting for commercial markets⁴³ • The baseline is calculated using BL-DFW and fuel wood or charcoal is harvested for commercial markets In all other circumstances, the module shall not be used.	Where REDD project activities result in reductions in timber harvest, it is likely that production can be transferred to other areas of the country to compensate for the reduction. The module is required when the deforestation process involves harvesting timber for commercial markets (Commercial markets are defined here as the sale of products to end-users and public and private companies. Public and private companies with sales carried out at a distant distance (>50 km) from the project area). In the case of the project, the deforestation process in the baseline involves commercial logging, as a common practice of landowners in the region.
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⁴³ Commercial markets here defined as sale of products to end users and public and private companies with sales conducted distant (>50km) from the project area.

VMD0013 E-BPB	This module provides a step-wise approach for estimating greenhouse emissions from biomass and peat burning. This module is applicable to REDD project activities with emissions from biomass burning	In the baseline scenario, fire is used to clear the land, and emissions of CO ₂ , N ₂ O, and CH ₄ result. Where used in the baseline, accounting must occur under both the baseline and with project scenarios in both the project area and in the leakage belt. Where fires occur <i>ex-post</i> in areas that coincide with areas deforested or degraded in the baseline case, the module shall be used to account for greenhouse gas emissions.
VMD0014 E-FFC	This module provides a stepwise approach to estimating emissions from fossil fuel combustion in Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD) projects.	All fossil fuel combustion associated with a project may be accounted for, including fossil fuel combustion of subcontractors that are conducting (parts of the) work to implement the project. Fossil fuel combustion in all situations is an optional emission source. Project proponents may, however, elect to include fossil fuel combustion if emissions are higher in the baseline than in the project case thus generating emission reductions through project activities. Where emissions from fossil fuel combustion are estimated in the baseline, monitoring and estimation must also occur in the with-project scenario ⁴⁴
VMD0015 M-REDD	The module is mandatory. In addition, the stratification is fixed ex-ante for the baseline and will not be changed and there are no selective logging activities	Strata, as defined in the relevant baseline modules, are fixed and may not be changed without baseline revision.

⁴⁴ Emissions due to fossil fuel combustion both inside and outside the project boundary will be considered project emissions.

	taking place in the project area. The other conditions do not apply.	The module is mandatory for REDD, CIW-REDD, RWE-REDD, and stand-alone CIW projects Where selective logging is taking place in the project case: • Emissions from logging may be omitted if it can be demonstrated the emissions are de minimis using Tool T-SIG. • If emissions from logging are not omitted as de minimis, logging may only take place within forest management areas that possess and maintain a Forest Stewardship Council (FSC) certificate for the years when the selective logging occurs. • Logging operations may only conduct selective logging that maintains a land cover that meets the definition of forest within the project boundary. • All trees cut for timber extraction during logging operations must have a DBH greater than 30 cm. • During logging operations, only the bole/log of the felled tree may be removed. The top/crown of the tree must remain within the forested area. • The logging practices cannot include the piling and/or burning of the logging slash. • The volume of timber harvested must be measured and monitored.
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VMD0016 X-STR	This module provides guidance on stratifying the project area into discrete, relatively homogeneous units to improve accuracy and precision of carbon stock and carbon stock change estimates.	Any module referencing strata shall be used in combination with this module. Strata are only used for pre-deforestation forest classes and are the same in baseline and project cases. Post deforestation (conversion) land uses are not stratified, instead using average post deforestation stock values.
VMD0017 X-UNC	This module is applicable for estimating the uncertainty of estimates of emissions and removals of CO ₂ e generated from REDD and WRC project activities.	This module is mandatory when using the methodology REDD+ MF, which is applied to the project. Guidance on uncertainty a precision target of a 95% confidence interval half-width equal to or less than 15% of the recorded value must be targeted. This is especially important in terms of project planning for the measurement of carbon stocks; sufficient measurement plots should be included to achieve this precision level across the measured stocks.
VT0001 T-ADD	AFOLU activities the same or similar to the proposed project activity on the land within the proposed project boundary performed with or without being registered as the VCS AFOLU project shall not lead to violation of any applicable law even if the law is not enforced	As stated in the section 1.15, the project is in compliance with all relevant laws, statutes, and regulatory frameworks.

	The use of this tool to determine additionality requires the baseline methodology to provide for a stepwise approach justifying the determination of the most plausible baseline scenario. Project Proponent(s) proposing new baseline methodologies shall ensure consistency between the determination of a baseline scenario and the determination of the additionality of a project activity.	The approach to defining the baseline scenario using this tool will be described in section 3.5 of the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.
AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool	There are no internal applicability conditions	This tool does not provide any applicability conditions. For additional information regarding the risk assessment and buffer determination assumptions.

3.3 Project Boundary

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

3.4 Baseline Scenario

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

3.5 Additionality

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

3.5.1 Regulatory Surplus

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

3.5.2 Additionality Methods

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

3.6 Methodology Deviations

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

4 QUANTIFICATION OF ESTIMATED GHG EMISSION REDUCTIONS AND REMOVALS

4.1 Baseline Emissions

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

4.2 Project Emissions

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

4.3 Leakage Emissions

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

4.4 Estimated GHG Emission Reductions and Carbon Dioxide Removals

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

5 MONITORING

5.1 Data and Parameters Available at Validation

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

5.2 Data and Parameters Monitored

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.

5.3 Monitoring Plan

Section not required for Draft Projection Description. Further information will be inserted into the fully complete Draft Projection Description Version 01.